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MAGIC: THE GATHERING® | TEENAGE MUTANT NINJA TURTLES MECHANICS

Feature Feb 17, 2026



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Cowabunga, dudes. The heroes in a half shell are headed to battlefields near you, and they're bringing their fierce allies, their sweet weapons, and their most fearsome enemies along with them. All your favorite characters are here, but where they really want to be is in your decks. Let's look at the keywords and other game mechanics in *Magic: The Gathering® | Teenage Mutant Ninja Turtles* so you don't suffer from *shell shock* when you open the cards. Too derivative? I guess you'll really be able to *shell* out some damage! Too cliché? It's a *shell* of a good set! You'll love playing with the Turtles!

MUTAGEN

It's no secret—without the ooze that mutated the Turtles to begin with, their lives would have turned out differently and I'd be writing about the Foot Clan set. *Mutagen* is a new kind of token that helps your creatures achieve greater potential.



Michelangelo, Weirdness to 11

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Mutagen Token

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Draft Night

Each Mutagen token is an artifact token with "1, ♣, Sacrifice this token: Put a +1/+1 counter on target creature. Activate only as a sorcery." Of course, Mikey, being a little weird, isn't satisfied with only one +1/+1 counter and will chip in another for you. In addition to the obvious benefits of making your creatures larger, the set also has ways to reward you for controlling artifacts or having artifacts you control enter. Mutagen is great for all of this.

SNEAK

Shouting "Cowabunga!" as you run toward your enemy is flashy and makes for a good movie scene or comic panel, but sometimes it's best if they don't see you coming. *Sneak* is a new

keyword that gives you an optional alternative cost to cast a spell.



You can cast a spell for its sneak cost only during the declare blockers step inside of combat during your turn, after blockers have been declared. If you cast a spell for its sneak cost, you do so any time you could cast an instant, meaning you could cast it in response to another spell or ability. Part of the alternative cost is listed after the sneak keyword—in Leonardo's case, that's the **2** . There's another part to the cost, though. You also return an unblocked attacking creature you control to its owner's hand.

Because the returning creature jumps back to its owner's hand as part of the cost, players can't respond by trying to take out the attacking creature. It's already back in its owner's hand by the time players can respond to the spell.

If the spell with sneak is a creature spell, that creature will enter tapped and attacking whomever or whatever the creature you returned was attacking. Note that this is a rule specific to sneak (and ninjutsu before it). Normally as a creature enters attacking, you get to choose which player, planeswalker, or battle the creature is attacking. Returning a creature may set your battlefield presence back a step, but it's a great way to regain access to

powerful "enters" abilities, not to mention the mana savings on the sneak spells themselves. Plus, as blockers have already been declared, your opponent will suddenly have an unexpected enemy at their doorstep.

Not every card with sneak is a creature card. Didn't see that one coming, did you? What? There were early previews, and you *did* see that one coming? Look, over there!



Sorceries with sneak operate under the same timing rules as creatures. You can cast one for its sneak cost any time you could cast an instant during the declare blockers step inside of combat during your turn. And the way the sneak cost works is the same—an unblocked attacker is still returning to hand.

Remember that sneak is optional. You can always cast a card with sneak for its mana cost. You won't return any creatures to hand, and in the case of creatures with sneak, they won't enter tapped and attacking.

DISAPPEAR

The battlefield can be a chaotic place. Fists flying. Weapons twirling. Shells spinning. And then suddenly ... ninja vanish. *Disappear* is a new ability word that, curiously, appears before abilities that care in some way if a permanent left the battlefield while under your control during the turn.



Disappear abilities will look back at the entire turn, even if the permanent that has the disappear ability wasn't on the battlefield at the time. For example, cast a creature spell using sneak to return an unblocked attacker to its owner's hand, then cast **Krang & Shredder** after combat. The last ability of **Krang & Shredder** will trigger at the beginning of that turn's end step, even though you didn't control **Krang & Shredder** when the creature left the battlefield.

ALLIANCE

Unless you're Donatello in the original arcade game, we all need a little help sometimes. *Alliance* is a returning ability word that highlights abilities of creatures that trigger whenever another creature you control enters.



There's nothing fancy about alliance abilities. Pack your deck with creatures or ways to create creature tokens and reap the rewards. If you control multiple creatures that each have an alliance ability and a creature you control enters, all of their alliance abilities trigger. Those abilities can be put on the stack in any order, and the last one to be put on the stack will be the first one to resolve. If the entering creature itself has an enters triggered ability, that ability gets thrown in the mix with all the alliance abilities.

CLASSES

As Master Splinter likes to remind us, we shouldn't neglect our training. *Class* enchantments are back, and they're ready to help us hone our skills, one level at a time.



Each Class has three sections in its text box, with an activated level ability above each of the last two. Class abilities can be anything—triggered abilities like **Ninja Teen**'s first Class ability, static abilities like **Ninja Teen**'s other Class abilities, or even activated abilities. Those Class abilities are active as long as the Class has the appropriate level. Classes start at level 1, meaning only abilities in the top section of the text box are functional at first.

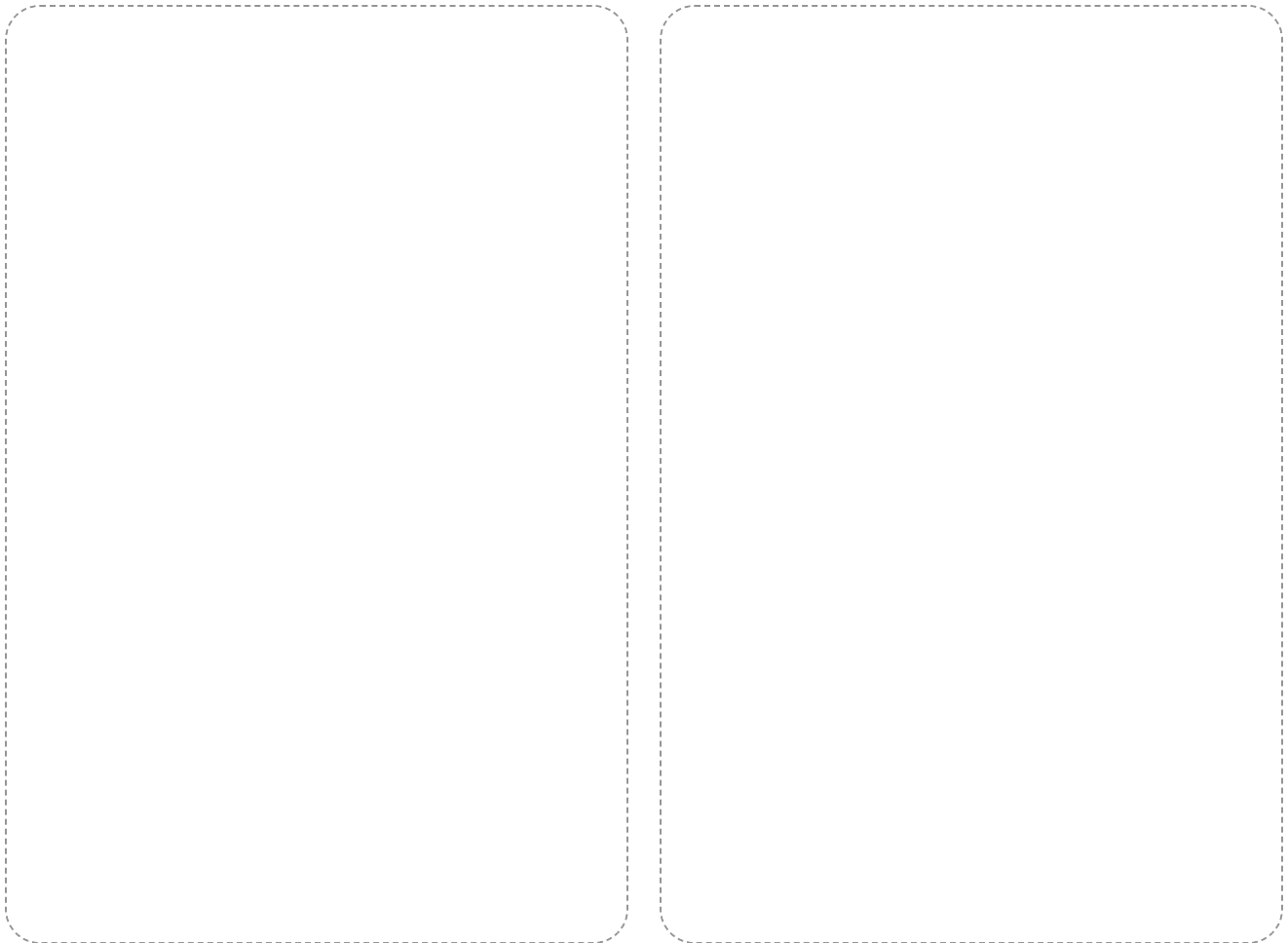
Master Splinter once said, "The path that leads to what we truly desire is long and difficult." Fortunately for you, the path to what you truly desire from a Class card is "pay some mana." You can do that as a sorcery, meaning during your main phase if the stack is empty, you can activate the level 2 ability. For **Ninja Teen**, that will cost you **1** . As that ability resolves, the Class will become level 2 and the first two text box sections will become active. Notably, a Class's level isn't tracked with or represented by counters. A Class's level is just something true about that permanent.

If a Class is level 2, it's eligible to become level 3. For **Ninja Teen**, pay  and all of its abilities are ready to rock. You do have to gain the levels in order. You can't jump straight from level 1 to level 3. No cheating, Mikey! (It's probably Mikey. Let's be real.)

You can control any number of Class enchantments, even multiples of the same one. Our heroes are Renaissance Turtles, after all. They act independently, though, so if you control two **Ninja Teens**, advancing one to level 2 has no effect on the other one. But if you can get both to level 2, creatures you control will enjoy the bonuses from each of them.

PARTNER—CHARACTER SELECT (COMMANDER)

While the Turtles are prepared to go it alone, their adventures have proved it's always better for someone to have your back. Partner—Character select is a new variant of the partner keyword that allows you to have two commanders if both have that keyword.



A commander with partner—Character select can share top billing only with another one. You can't mix and match with the original partner ability or other variants such as partner—Friends forever. Use the combined color identity of both cards to determine what cards can be in the rest of your deck. For example, if Splinter and Donatello are your commanders, your deck can include cards whose color identities are blue and/or black, as well as basic Islands and Swamps, but it couldn't have a card with a red mana symbol on it or a Forest.

You are allowed to have a single commander with partner—Character select, and you are allowed to play cards with partner even when they're not your commander. You won't make Splinter mad. Disappointed, maybe.

TURTLE POWER

Your opportunity to grab a *pizza* the action is almost here. *Magic: The Gathering* | *Teenage Mutant Ninja Turtles* previews are being delivered as we speak, with the set's worldwide release on March 6. The set is available for preorder now from [your local game store](#), [TCGplayer](#), [Amazon](#), and elsewhere *Magic* is sold. Then go ninja go to the Prerelease!



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